

Claude Usage Strategy for a Daily Student User focused on Deep Research, Coding, Content Creation, and Marketing



YOUR CLAUDE STRATEGY

Student · Daily User · Deep Research

Coding · Research & Learning · Content Creation · Marketing & Business Planning

WHICH MODEL TO USE WHEN

Fast & light

Haiku

Quick lookups, simple definitions, short rewrites, grammar checks.

Use for: summarizing a paragraph, explaining a term, basic Q&A, quick code snippets.

Your primary model

Sonnet

The best balance of speed, depth, and quality for a daily student workflow.

Use for: essays, code debugging, structured research notes, marketing drafts, most daily tasks.

Deep power

Opus

For your hardest, most complex tasks where quality trumps speed.

Use for: thesis-level research, complex multi-file code, nuanced business strategy, high-stakes writing.

EFFORT LEVEL GUIDE

- Low
Casual questions, quick definitions, simple formatting tasks.
- Standard (your default)
Most daily tasks — notes, code, content drafts, research summaries.
- High
Research papers, detailed code architecture, nuanced essay arguments.
- Max
Thesis work, final project submissions, high-stakes deliverables only.

PERSONALIZED WORKFLOW TABLE

Task	Model	Effort	Reason
Understand a concept / lecture notes	Haiku	Standard	Fast explanations, no heavy compute needed
Research paper outline & draft	Sonnet	High	Needs structured thinking and academic depth
Deep literature review / thesis section	Opus	Max	Maximum reasoning for complex, high-stakes work
Debugging code / writing functions	Sonnet	Standard	Strong code quality without heavy wait time
Complex multi-file code architecture	Opus	High	Deep reasoning across interconnected files
Blog post / social media content	Sonnet	Standard	Good creative output at speed
Marketing plan / business case draft	Sonnet	High	Strategic structure benefits from higher effort

Task	Model	Effort	Reason
Quick grammar / spelling check	Haiku	Low	Simple task — save tokens and time
Exam prep / practice Q&A	Sonnet	Standard	Reliable explanations with good depth
Competitive analysis / market research	Opus	High	Nuanced synthesis across many factors

BIGGEST MISTAKES TO AVOID

Using Opus for every task — it's slower and uses more of your usage limits. Reserve it for genuinely complex work.

Leaving effort on Max by default — this burns through your limits fast. Standard covers 80% of student needs.

Vague prompts like "help me write an essay." Always specify topic, length, audience, and tone for better results.

Not iterating — Claude's first draft is a starting point. Ask it to refine, expand, or restructure for much better output.

Using Haiku for deep research — it lacks the reasoning depth. Don't sacrifice quality on important academic work.

FINAL RECOMMENDATION

IF YOU COULD ONLY PICK ONE

Claude Sonnet · Standard effort

Sonnet at Standard effort is the perfect daily driver for a student with your range of tasks. It handles coding, research, content, and planning with high quality and speed — without burning through your usage limits. Switch up to Opus + High/Max only when the stakes are genuinely high (thesis, final projects, complex architecture). Everything else? Sonnet Standard has you covered.